

vessel filled with warriors, which gives chase to Wäinämöinen and his companions. The old sage stops the progress of the enemy by flinging into the sea a splinter of flint and a scrap of tinder, which are at once converted into a large reef, against which the Poljola vessel strikes. Louhi herself now rushes into the midst of the engagement, assuming the form of a gigantic eagle, and bearing all her warriors, whom she rescues from the wreck, upon her wings and tail. On seeing the approach of this terrible bird, Wäinämöinen again proposes a division of the Sampo, which is again refused; and a sharp conflict now ensues, in the course of which all the warriors are shaken from the wings and tail of the eagle, who, with the single claw that is left her, snatches up the Sampo. It falls to pieces; and the larger fragments sink to the bottom of the sea, where they form the treasure of the water-god, while the smaller float ashore, to the delight of Wäinämöinen, who predicts that they will bring a blessing to Finland. To the enraged Louhi, who threatens to shut up the sun and moon in a rock, and to spoil Wäinämöinen's harvest by wild-beasts and inclement weather, he answers in a tone of pious confidence:

"If I trust in my Creator,
If I build upon the highest,
From the foe He will preserve me,
From the evil one my corn-field,
That the seed he may not injure,
That the growing ears he spoil not.
Oh, thou hostess of Poljola,
Hide the wicked in thy mountain;
But the sun, the blessed moonlight,
Ne'er by thee shall be imprisoned."

Louhi feels that her power has gone, and she returns home disconsolate, with nothing but the cover of the Sampo. Wäinämöinen, on the other hand, collects the particles which have floated ashore, and places them on a woody island, that they may produce rye and barley, the former for bread, the latter for beer.

Having brought this adventure to a happy issue, Wäinämöinen now feels the want of his harp; and having persuaded Ilmarinen to make for him a long rake, sets out in a boat and rakes the whole sea, in the hope of finding the instrument. His search proving fruitless, he makes for himself a new harp of a birch-tree, which he strings with the hair of a lovely girl, and once more sings a song which entrances every living creature.

In the mean while Louhi, hearing of the prosperity of Wäinämöinen, is consumed with envy, and resolves, if she can, to work more mischief. The arrival at her house of Loviatar, the youngest and worst daughter of the infernal god Tuoni, provides her with new weapons; for her horrible guest gives birth to nine sons, who are so many personified diseases. These are despatched to molest the people of Kalewala; but the sick persons are healed by the medicines and prayers of the sage, who especially addresses himself to another daughter of Tuoni, called the "daughter of pain," imploring her to put all the maladies into a vessel, bear them to the top